

INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

THE SITE

Location Amazon IAD86, VA -- station KIAD, America/New_York
Committed pair OSM 1181391920 -> 544596573
Amazon IAD86 / Amazon IAD63
Facade gap 152.3 m between the two halls
Weather record 43,763 real hourly records from KIAD
Plume physics 576 steady-state solves on this site's own footprints; worst intake rise 0.3611 C at 270 deg

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2025-03-11 (crossing)
Plant limit 18.0 C
Notice required 3 h
Forecast skill 0.50 relative to persistence
Level anchor sensor
Condenser bank longest facade
Switch budget 1 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell 3 h
Max dew point 15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6)

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 2 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. The reactive incumbent took 13 hours -- 11 more -- but declared 1 unsafe hour against the agent's 0. The incumbent had to break its own switch budget 1 time to stay safe; the agent never did. 12 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 2 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent 13 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 1 unsafe hour(s)
the incumbent broke its own switch budget 1 time(s) to stay safe
12 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	mechanical	yes	switch budget	4.394	18.0	4.119	1.130
01	mechanical	yes	switch budget	4.394	18.0	4.119	1.071
02	mechanical	yes	switch budget	4.114	18.0	3.009	1.240
03	mechanical	yes	switch budget	3.014	18.0	1.424	1.114
04	mechanical	yes	switch budget	3.009	18.0	0.789	1.069

05	mechanical	yes	switch budget	2.424	18.0	0.229	1.245
06	mechanical	yes	switch budget	1.064	18.0	-0.881	1.060
07	mechanical	yes	switch budget	2.729	18.0	0.229	1.713
08	mechanical	yes	switch budget	6.218	18.0	5.560	1.899
09	mechanical	yes	switch budget	10.056	18.0	11.447	2.435
10	mechanical	yes	switch budget	11.685	18.0	13.898	2.318
11	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.489	18.0	17.780	1.812
12	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.325	18.0	19.440	1.422
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.896	18.0	21.111	1.164
14	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.303	18.0	22.029	1.370
15	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.626	18.0	22.784	1.068
16	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	23.116	18.0	22.784	1.210
17	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.719	18.0	22.224	1.442
18	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.222	18.0	21.110	1.396
19	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	20.777	18.0	18.890	1.442
20	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	20.346	18.0	17.780	1.630
21	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.768	18.0	15.574	1.750
22	FREE	yes	-	15.794	18.0	12.222	1.420
23	FREE	yes	-	15.764	18.0	13.330	1.162

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin
actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record
margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 4.394 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

01:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 4.394 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

02:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 4.114 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

03:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 3.014 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 3.009 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a

thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 2.424 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 1.064 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

07:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 2.729 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

08:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 6.218 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

09:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 10.056 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

10:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 11.685 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

11:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.489 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

12:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.325 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.325 C. It would take a limit 0.325 C higher, or a bound 0.325 C tighter, to change this hour.

13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.896 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.896 C. It would take a limit 1.896 C higher, or a bound 1.896 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.304 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.304 C. It would take a limit 4.304 C higher, or a bound 4.304 C tighter, to change this hour.

15:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.626 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.626 C. It would take a limit 4.626 C higher, or a bound 4.626 C tighter, to change this hour.

16:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 23.116 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 5.116 C. It would take a limit 5.116 C higher, or a bound 5.116 C tighter, to change this hour.

17:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.719 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.719 C. It would take a limit 4.719 C higher, or a bound 4.719 C tighter, to change this hour.

18:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.222 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.222 C. It would take a limit 4.222 C higher, or a bound 4.222 C tighter, to change this hour.

19:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 20.778 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 2.778 C. It would take a limit 2.778 C higher, or a bound 2.778 C tighter, to change this hour.

20:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 20.346 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 2.346 C. It would take a limit 2.346 C higher, or a bound 2.346 C tighter, to change this hour.

21:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.768 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.768 C. It would take a limit 0.768 C higher, or a bound 0.768 C tighter, to change this hour.

22:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 15.794 C, which is 2.206 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.420 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.189 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.2308 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

23:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 15.763 C, which is 2.237 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.162 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.953 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.2084 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

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